

Using Maschina

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For owners and traders: creating a machine, funding it, reading it, stopping it

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Abstract

A practical guide for the person whose money this is. What you are actually doing when you create a machine, which limits matter most, how to read a record, how to stop something, and how to start in a way you will not regret. Capabilities described here are subject to the operational status in document 14.

1. What you are actually doing

You create a machine, give it a job, fund it, and set what it may do. It does that work, records everything, and pays you what it makes. You can pause it, stop it, tighten its limits or read its history at any moment.

You are the owner. It is the worker. Its money comes from you and returns only to you, and that last part is enforced by a party that has never heard of us.

Creating one

Choose a job. Each kind does one thing. Buy on a schedule. Act when a price crosses a level. Hold a position and close it at a threshold. Work a range. Hold a portfolio at target weights.

Set the terms. Which assets it may touch, the most it may spend in total, per action and per day, and when it may act.

Create it. A wallet is created, a policy is written onto it, and that policy is read back and verified before your machine exists. If anything fails to match, nothing is created.

Fund it. Send funds from your own wallet to the machine's address. Send a small amount first and confirm it arrived before sending the rest. This costs you five minutes and has saved people a great deal more than that.

Start it.

Funding and budget are different things. Funding puts assets in the wallet. The budget is permission to spend them, and it lives in the record. A machine holding a thousand with a budget of fifty may spend fifty.

2. The limits worth thinking about

Total budget. The most it can ever spend.

Per action. The largest single trade.

Per day. The most in twenty four hours. Set this lower than feels necessary. It is the limit that protects you when a strategy meets a market it was not designed for, which will happen.

Approved assets. Anything not approved is refused by the wallet itself, not by a setting.

Window. The hours it may act.

A limit you did not set is not permission. A machine missing a required limit does not start.

3. Reading the record

Every machine keeps a complete history: each decision, the reasoning, and the result. For a trade that means what was exchanged, at what price, against which independent price that quote was checked, what it truly cost after fees, and how long it took from decision to landing.

Beside it, always, is the benchmark: what simply holding would have done over the same period. Most automated trading underperforms that benchmark [3][4]. You should be able to see

immediately whether yours does, and we would rather you find out from us than from your own bank balance six months later.

4. Control

Pause stops action and keeps everything. Reversible.

Stop is permanent. A machine that could restart itself is a machine you cannot switch off, so that transition does not exist. Create a new one instead.

Stop everything halts every machine you own at once.

Tighten limits at any time, effective on the next action.

5. Getting your money out

Funds return to the wallet you own. It is the only destination the machine's wallet permits, so withdrawal is not a permission we grant. It is the only thing that can happen.

The procedure for recovering funds directly from the key management provider, without us and without us continuing to exist, is published and kept current.

6. Starting in a way you will not regret

Begin in simulation: live prices, real decisions, nothing at risk. With real funds, begin with an amount whose total loss would not change your week. Run one machine before running five, and read its record daily for the first week.

Prefer a machine you can explain in one sentence to one you cannot. Treat any strategy that appears unable to lose as a strategy you do not yet understand.

7. What this does not do

It does not predict prices. It does not give advice. It does not promise returns, and nobody here will ever tell you what a machine is likely to make.

What it guarantees is narrower and worth considerably more: a machine cannot spend beyond what you allowed, cannot touch assets you did not approve, cannot send funds to anyone but you, and cannot hide what it did.

8. Fees

Charged on work performed, never on profits. Faster execution paths cost more than scheduled ones. Current rates are on the pricing page.

9. Where we go

Documentation at docs.maschina.dev. Service status at status.maschina.dev. Security reports go through maschina.dev/.well-known/security.txt.

10. References

- [3] F. Chague, R. De-Losso and B. Giovannetti. *Day Trading for a Living?* SSRN 3423101.
- [4] B. Barber and T. Odean. *Trading is Hazardous to Your Wealth*, and subsequent work.